Lesson 4 — One Small Thing, Many Times

Part 5 of 12: The short forms of have and has

Level: A2+ (fourth step)

About 20 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

3.3 The short forms of have and has (listen to `05-have-has-forms.mp3`)

In speech, have and has are almost never said in full. They join the word before them and become very short. This is why the present perfect is hard to hear even when it is easy to write.

FULL	SHORT FORM	SOUND
I have	I've	/aɪv/
you have	you've	/juːv/
they have	they've	/ðeɪv/
he has	he's	/hiːz/
she has	she's	/ʃiːz/
it has	it's	/ɪts/
have not	haven't	/ˈhævənt/
has not	hasn't	/ˈhæzənt/

Inside a sentence, a full have or has is also weak and quiet: /həv/ and /həz/, not /hæv/ and /hæz/.

The one that catches everybody

she's is two different words.

YOU HEAR	IT MEANS	HOW YOU KNOW
She's finished the course.	she has finished	a past participle comes after it
She's a student.	she is a student	a noun or an adjective comes after it

The word after she's tells you which one it is. The same is true of he's and it's.

In the audio you hear each pair twice — the full form, then the short one — and then a test: say whether the 's you hear means has or is, and listen to the answer.